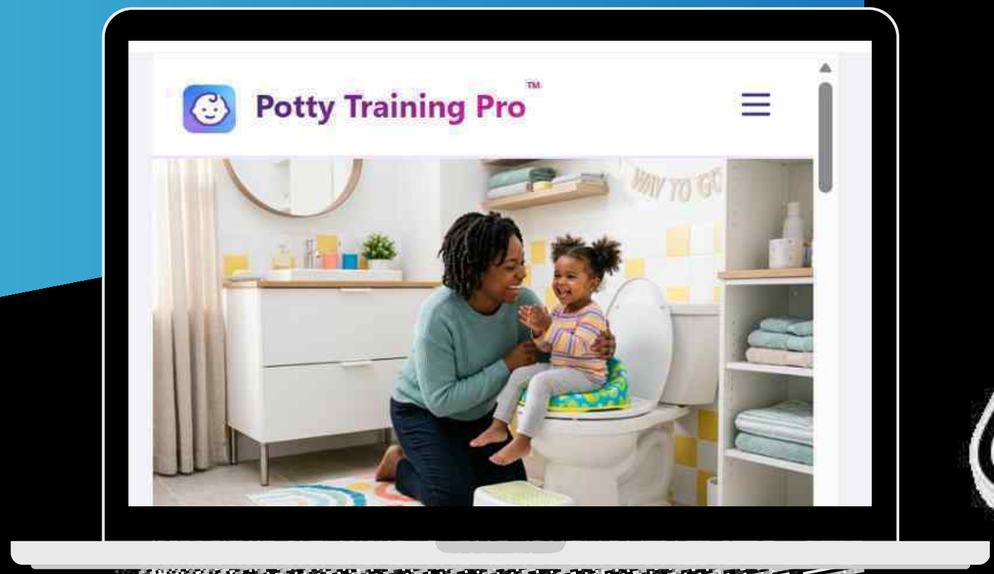
From Prompt to Product: How I Used AI to Design, Build, Integrate, and Launch Real Apps

Presented By

LaShawnda Rodgers, MBA, PMP, CSM







BIO

LaShawnda Rodgers is a technology and digital transformation executive, AI strategist, and founder and CEO of Rodgers Global Enterprises.

With more than 20 years of experience spanning enterprise technology implementations, software and product development, strategic program leadership, organizational transformation, and workforce innovation, she helps organizations turn complex ideas into practical solutions.

She is also Tech Vibe Collective co-founder, Tech Ladies mentor, Longtime Blacks in Technology community leader, and an advisor to Wake Tech and Durham Tech, supporting the next generation of technology talent. She also works with school systems, students, and community partners to strengthen technology access, career pathways, and workforce readiness.

LaShawnda Rodgers, MBA, PMP, CSM



LEARNING OUTCOMES

What You will Leave With



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01	**Repeatable process**	Discover → define → design → build → integrate → test → launch
02	**Better prompts**	Move beyond one-line requests to context, constraints, roles and acceptance criteria.
03	**Better judgment**	Spot invented assumptions, manage scope, and independently verify results.
04	**Communication Tools**	Tools to enhance your customer experience and make development accessibil
05	**Technical Confidence**	Inner confidence in yours solution that solves probl family and you

Talk to Your People

Real insights come from real conversations.



01 VISIBILITY

02 FEEDBACK

03 TRACTION

FIND & OBSERVE

ENGAGE & LISTEN

TURN INSIGHT INTO ACTION

LinkedIn + Reddit

Industry and interest-based conversations, feedback and problem discovery.

Facebook groups

Relevant parent, caregiver and community groups; participate within group rules.

Social Media

Search X and TikTok posts asking for app suggestions or complaints about current apps.

Test Demand. Validate the Problem.
Build What's Worth Building.

Use Google Trends and Reddit to validate your app idea with real search interest and audience conversations.

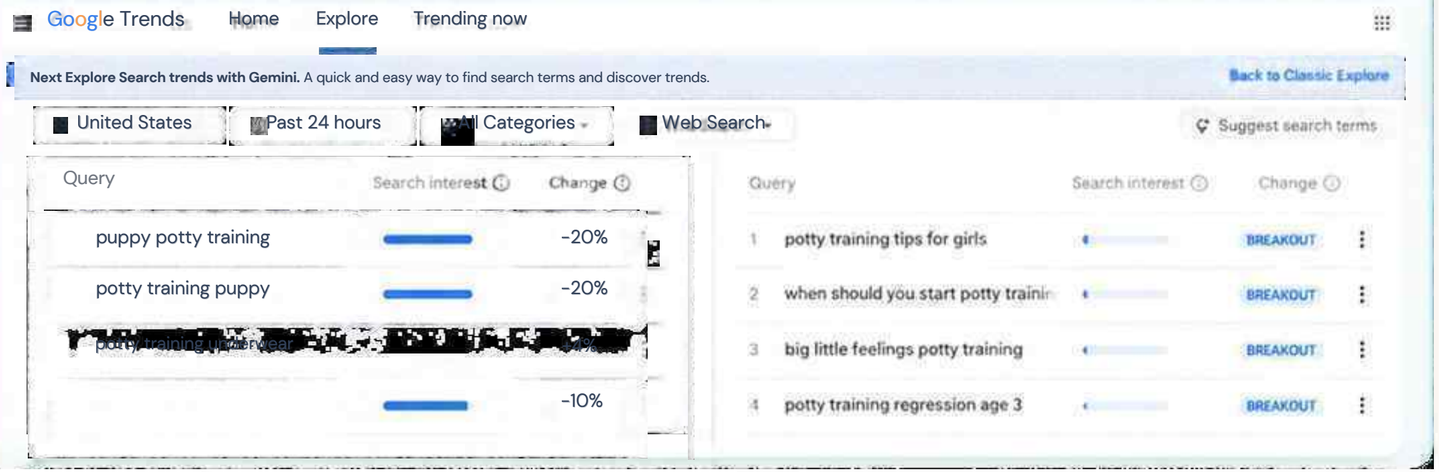
Google Trends | reddit



Evidence over assumptions.
Use real user behavior and conversations to decide if your idea is worth building.

Explore Search Demand

Use Google Trends to uncover what people are searching for and how interest is changing over time.



Validate with Real Conversations

Use Reddit to see how real people talk about the problem, their struggles, and what they need.



A Simple Framework to Decide if Your Idea is Worth Building

Validate
Find search demand and real conversations to confirm the problem exists.

→

Learn
Understand the depth of the problem, user language, and unmet needs.

→

Decide
If there's consistent demand and real pain, the idea is worth building.

→

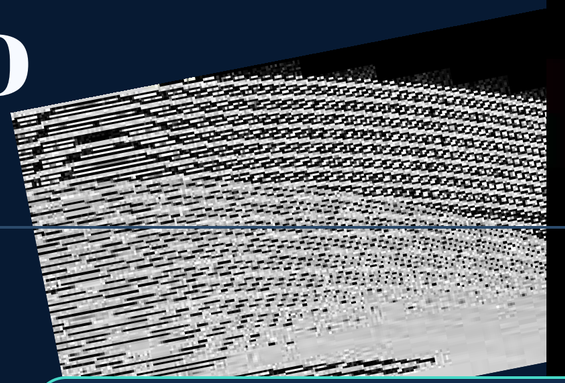
Build with Confidence
Move forward knowing you're solving a problem people care about.

Build with conviction. Validate first. Save time, reduce risk, and build something people truly need.

FROM IDEA TO PRODUCT SPECIFICATION

From Product Idea to Living PRD

A practical, repeatable path from an early idea to a validated guide for building.





01 Discover

What problem is worth solving? For whom? What evidence supports it?

→

02 Document

Problem • audience • outcomes • MVP • non-goals • integrations • risks.

→

03 Approve

AI drafts and organizes the PRD; the product owner validates every assumption.

A living PRD keeps the decision visible, testable, and ready to evolve.



Turning a Product Idea into a PRD





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PRD

TRADITIONAL PRD STRUCTURE

1. Problem statement
2. Target audience
3. User needs
4. MVP features
5. Integrations
6.

“LETTERLIFTS PRD EXAMPLE.

PROBLEM

Seniors struggle to understand important letters and next steps.

USERS

Older adults and trusted caregivers.

MVP

Upload, explain, identify actions, reminders.



Example of my PRD

A CLEAR FRAMEWORK FOR SMART FEATURE PLANNING

Planning the App Features

Define the job the product must do and the outcome users should experience.



Plan for Future Updates

Separate must-have MV features from later enhancements. Record assumptions, constraint and acceptance criteria.

List Essential Features

What is explicitly OUT of scope?



Avoid Unnecess Complexi

What does success look like for the user?

Identify the Main Purpose

What dependencies or integrations are required?



Designing a Friendly Interface

Start with user journeys, accessibility, clarity, trust, and emotional experience. Define how the app should feel and behave.

Easy to Use Design

- I often begin with structured questions and conversational requirements rather than a formal wireframe.
- Use prototypes and screenshots to validate what AI generates.
- Simple navigation and accessible contrast matter.

1 User Journey



Start with user journeys, accessibility, clarity, trust, and emotional experience. Define how the app should feel and behave.

2 Requirements



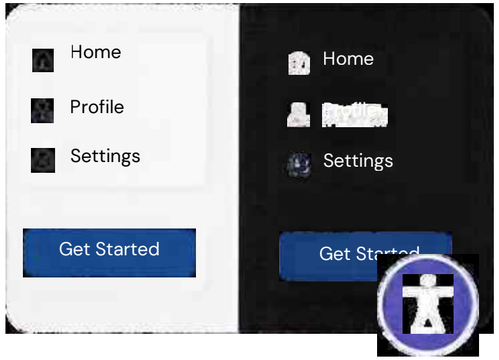
I often begin with structured questions and conversational requirements rather than a formal wireframe.

3 Prototype Validation



Use prototypes and screenshots to validate what AI generates.

4 Accessible Experience



Simple navigation and accessible contrast matter.

Choosing the Right Platform

Make a thoughtful choice based on what truly matters.





C&NF42

Think About User Access

My examples: Emergent for LetterLifts; Anything.com for Potty Training Pro.

Different applications can call for different builders.

DECISION CRITERIA

- Product complexity
- Integrations
- Data Ownership
- Support
- Maintenanace
- Cost



Emergent for LetterLifts

- Integration-rich application
- AI-assisted full-stack development
- Resend and third-party integrations
- Complex workflows and application logic
- Iterating on a working product



Anything.com for Potty Training Pro

- Supports efficient, flexible development
- Efficient credit usage and costs
- Ease of use and model flexibility
- Responsive customer support
- Fast issue resolution and feedback

TAKEAWAY: Different applications may call for different builders. Choose the platform that aligns best with your goals, resources, and roadmap.





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App Builder Selection Criteria

Use this checklist to evaluate platforms and choose the right fit for your product goals and long-term success.

1. Can it support the functionality my product requires?
2. Does it integrate with the services and APIs I need?
3. How much will building, testing, and maintaining the app cost?
4. How much flexibility and control do I have over the AI and code?
5. How easy is it to troubleshoot, deploy, and scale?
6. What happens when I need technical support?

Why I Chose Different AI Builders



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EMERGENT

LetterLifts

- Integration-rich application
- AI-assisted full-stack development
- Resend and third-party integrations
- Complex workflows and application logic
- Iterate on a working product

VS

ANYTHING.COM

Potty Training Pro

- Efficient, flexible development
- Efficient credit usage and costs
- Ease of use and model flexibility
- Responsive customer support
- Fast issue resolution and feedback

My takeaway: evaluate integration needs, cost, usability, flexibility, and support.

Two products. Two builder decisions.



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LetterLifts → Emergent

Complex workflows for seniors, letter explanations, action steps and trusted support.

Potty Training Pro → Anything.com

Parent-facing guidance, progress tracking,
voice options and subscription

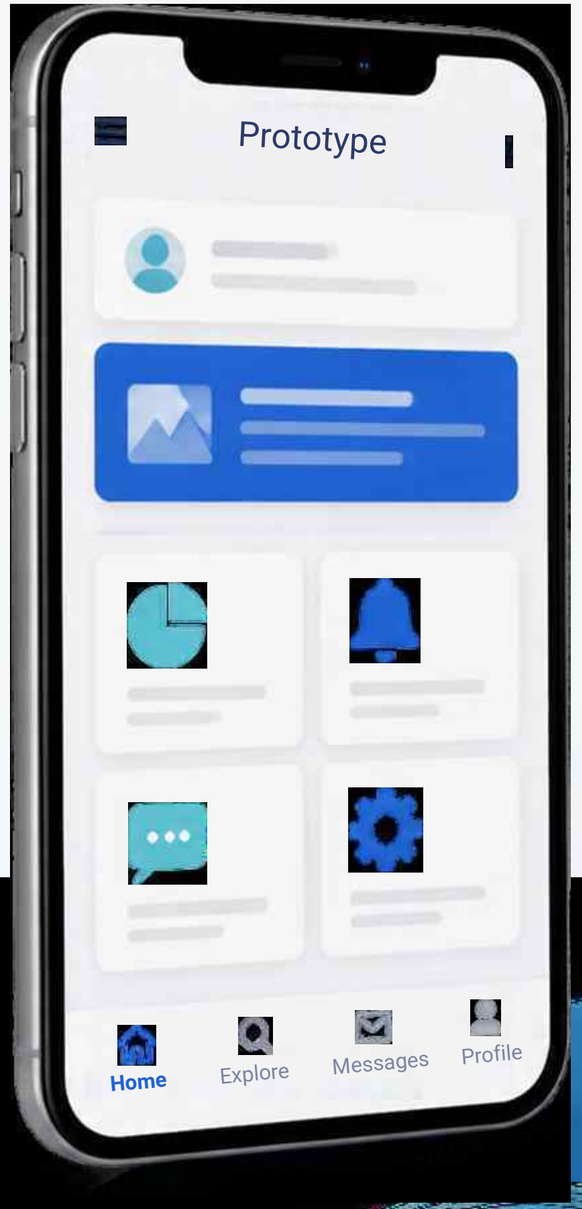
Selection criteria

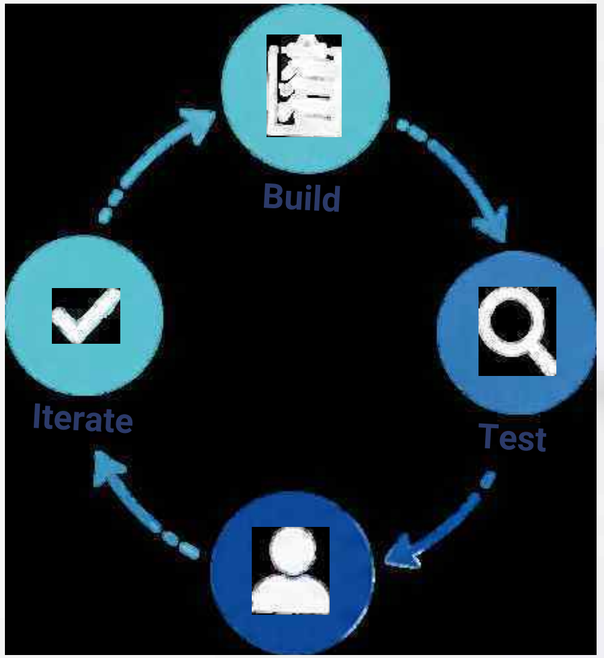
Integration depth | credits/cost | support | security | export/code | future scale

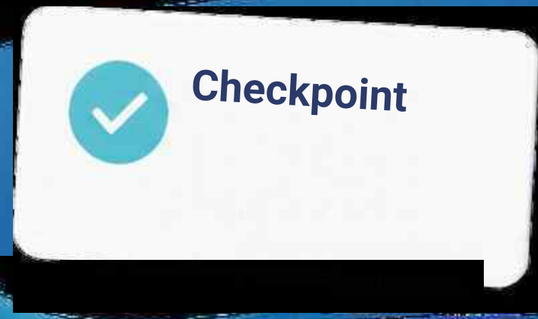


Building and Testing the App

Build in small, testable increments. Review each feature against the approved requirements and test real user journeys not just the screen appearance.









Prompt Oh My!

Even in casual chats, a structured prompt gets better results.

Can you build me an app?

...

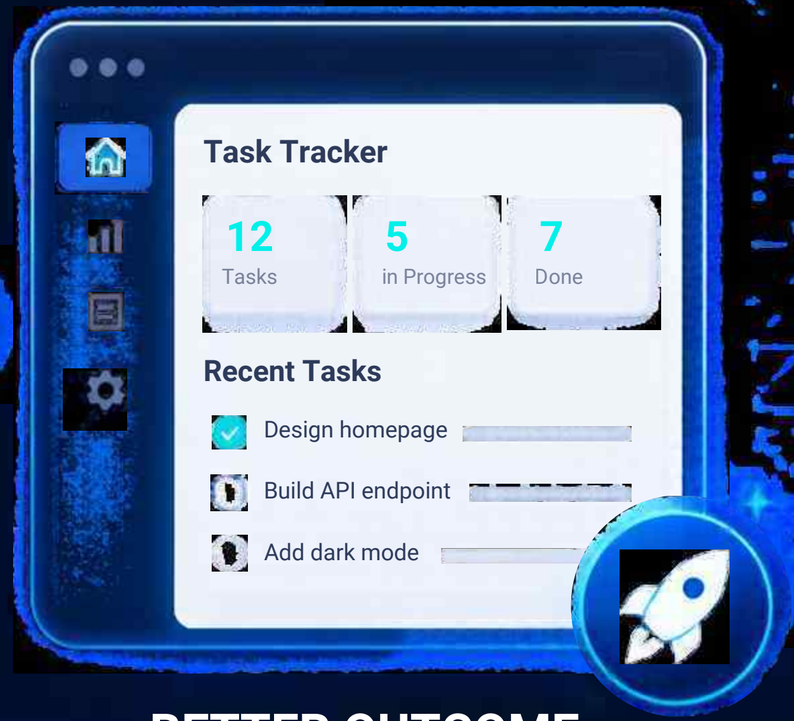
VAGUE CHAT

Unclear asks lead to unclear results.

- Role
- Instruction
- Example 1
- Example 2
- Example 3
- Context
- Question

STRUCTURED PROMPT

Give clear role, steps, examples, context, and a direct question.



BETTER OUTCOME

Structured prompts build better apps—faster.

Prompt Structuring



Novice prompt

"Build me an app that helps seniors understand letters."

Unclear audience requirements, scope, workflows, technical constraints, and success criteria.

Structured prompt

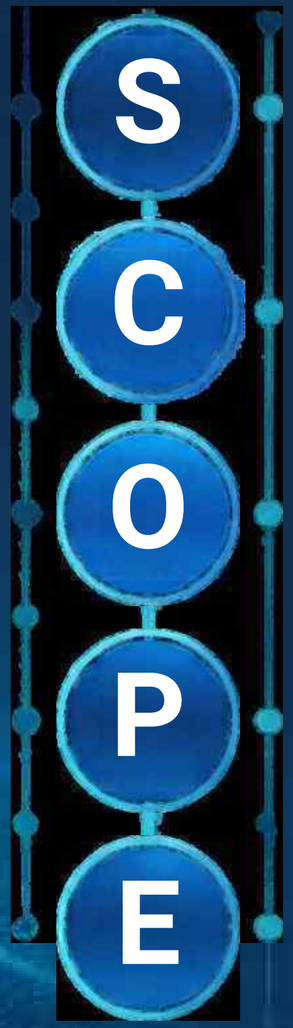
"Act as a senior full-stack product architect with expertise in accessibility, AI applications, and secure integrations..."

Defines expertise, customer needs, expected behavior, constraints, and deliverables.

Scope Control and Hallucination Detection







Specify

Define what the product must and must not do.

Check

Compare every proposed feature against the agreed requirements.

Observe

Watch for invented functionality, inaccurate claims, and unexpected changes.

Probe

Challenge AI outputs, inspect code, test assumptions, and consult independent sources.

Evaluate

Run functional, security, accessibility, and user-acceptance tests.



Security 🔒



Security feature	What it protects / how it works
Argon2 password hashing	Industry-standard, memory-hard algorithm (same family used by many banks)
Session-based authentication	Server-verified sessions, not client-trusted
Server-side authorization on every API route	e.g., Nicole's chat checks your identity before touching data, returns 401 if not logged in
Parameterized SQL queries	Built-in protection against SQL injection attacks
Server-side feature gating	Premium checks happen on the backend, so free users can't hack their way past the paywall
Secrets in environment variables	API keys never live in your code
HTTPS/TLS	Encrypted traffic on your published app
Email verification tokens	Single-use, expiring tokens for account flows

CASE STUDY



Security: Additional Protections 🔒🔒



- Data deletion rights — a "delete my account and all data" flow (GDPR/CCPA friendly)
- Rate limiting on AI chat endpoints to prevent abuse
- Audit logging — who accessed what, when
- Data retention policy — auto-purge old logs
- 2FA as a future enhancement for parent accounts

Cloud Services & Integrations

Service	What it does in your app
Anything platform	Hosting, serverless backend functions, auth infrastructure, publishing
Neon Postgres	Serverless database
Stripe	Premium subscription payments + checkout
OpenAI (ChatGPT)	Powers "Nicole," your AI potty-training expert, with streaming responses
Resend	Transactional email (welcome emails, etc.)
Uploadcare / CloudFront CDN	Image hosting + fast global delivery
React (web) + Expo (mobile)	Frontend frameworks — one codebase philosophy, two platforms



Openai Realtime

Real-time voice conversations powered by OpenAI Realtime.



1. **Your application server** creates an ephemeral client secret for the Realtime session.
2. **Your frontend** creates a `RealtimeSession`
3. **The session connects** over WebRTC in the browser or WebSocket on the server.
4. **The agent handles** audio turns, tools, interruptions, and handoffs inside that session.



Start a realtime voice session

```
import { RealtimeAgent, RealtimeSession } from "@openai/agents/realtime";
const agent = new RealtimeAgent( {
  name: "Assistant",
  instructions: "You are a helpful voice assistant.",
});
const session = new RealtimeSession(agent, {
  model: "gpt-realtime-2.1",));
];
```

```

await session.connect( {
  apiKey: “ek……. (ephemeral key from your server)”, }
;
```

Communication Accessibility



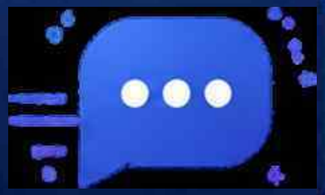
Resend

Application-generated emails and delivery records.



Telnyx

SMS capabilities, text-to-speech voices and communications workflows.



Voice architecture

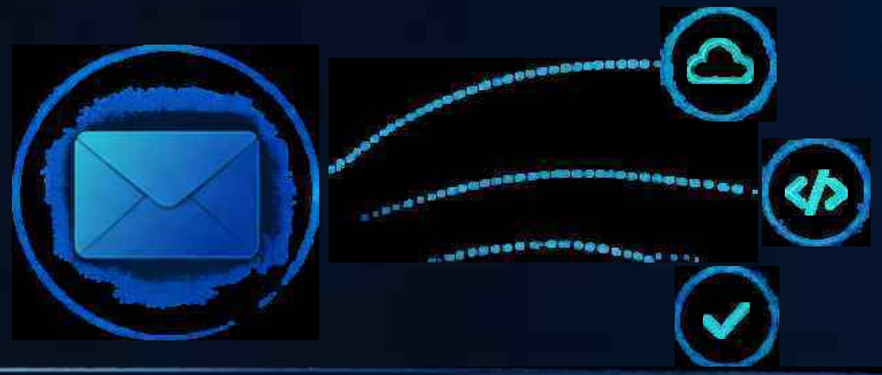
TTS is spoken output; two-way AI conversation also needs speech input, reasoning and response handling.



Resend

Reliable email delivery, fully integrated.

Configure, send, and personalize emails that your members actually see — and trust.



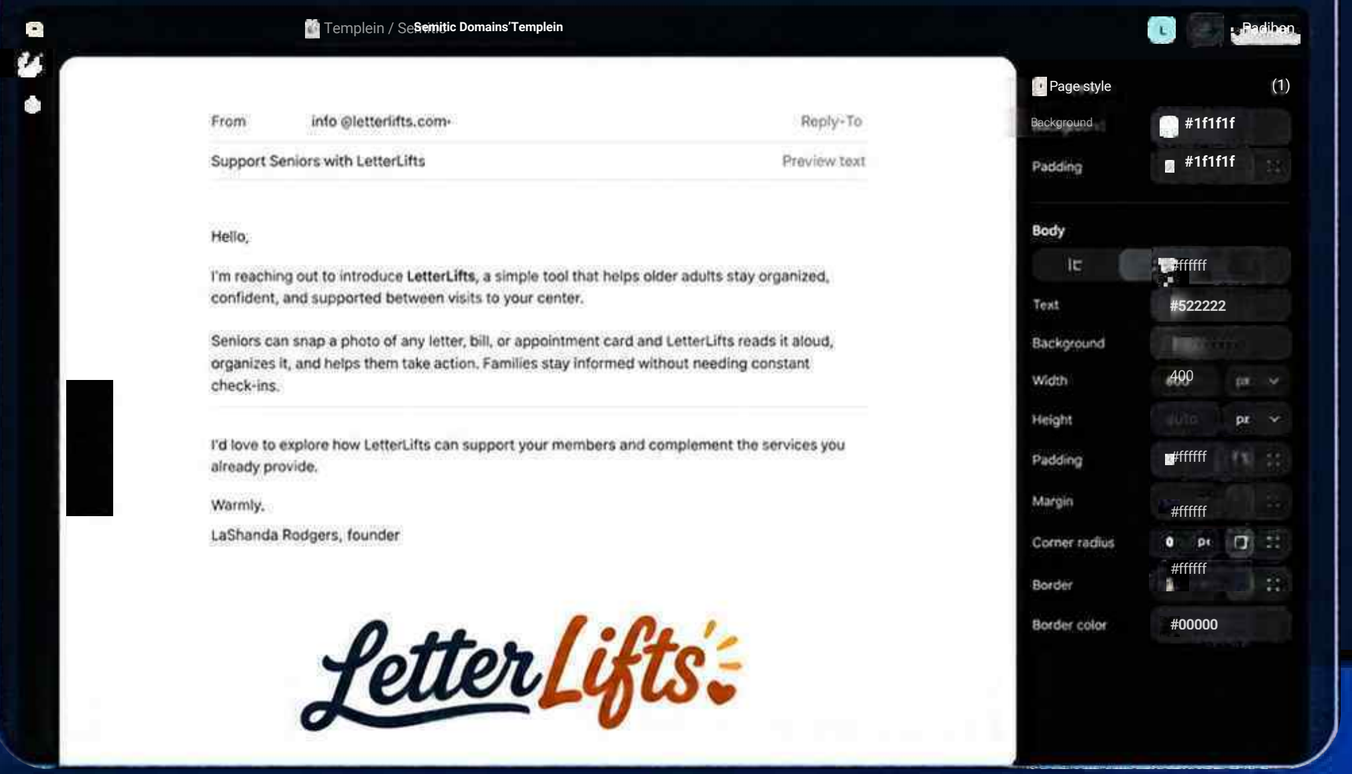
Emails
Resend App Settings

Sending | Receiving | Suppressions

[redacted] | Last 15 days | All Statuses | All API keys

To	Status	Subject	Sent
rodgers.global.leadership@gmail	Delivered	Someone you trust requested suppo...	30min ago
ms.lnrodgers@gmail.com	Delivered	A gentle reminder from LetterLifts	30min ago

LetterLifts Email Experience
Branded, helpful, and member-focused.



Trusted Delivery
Your emails land where they belong.

Seamless Integration
Built for developers. Easy for teams.

Better Member Experience
Clear, branded communication that builds trust.

Resend App Integration



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Delivery status

- Family notified by email — Sent
- Your reminder email — Sent
- SMS preview generated for Mo — text messages are turned off right now.

SECURE SUPPORT LINK

https://letterlifts.com/share/wzTP2An78da111-1010kp5u3UQPFJjQw

Copy link Open

Someone you trust requested support with an important next step

LetterLifts
TOP TIPS

LETTERLIFTS

Someone you trust asked for your help

Ele used LetterLifts to understand an important letter and asked you to help with the next step.

Action needed	Decide whether to keep your plan, switch, or return to Original Medicare — and contact Medicare if you want to change
Date	December 09, 2026
They chose to share	Summary

View the secure support page

This link expires on January 08, 2027. Do not attach the original letter unless the senior chose Full Support.

1. SIGNUPP

A trusted person requests support.

2. DELIVERY

Resend delivers emails reliably and securely.

3. COMMUNICATION

The trusted contact receives a clear, branded email with next steps.

Telnyx Reporting

Telnyx enhances the app and enables reporting.



App Communication

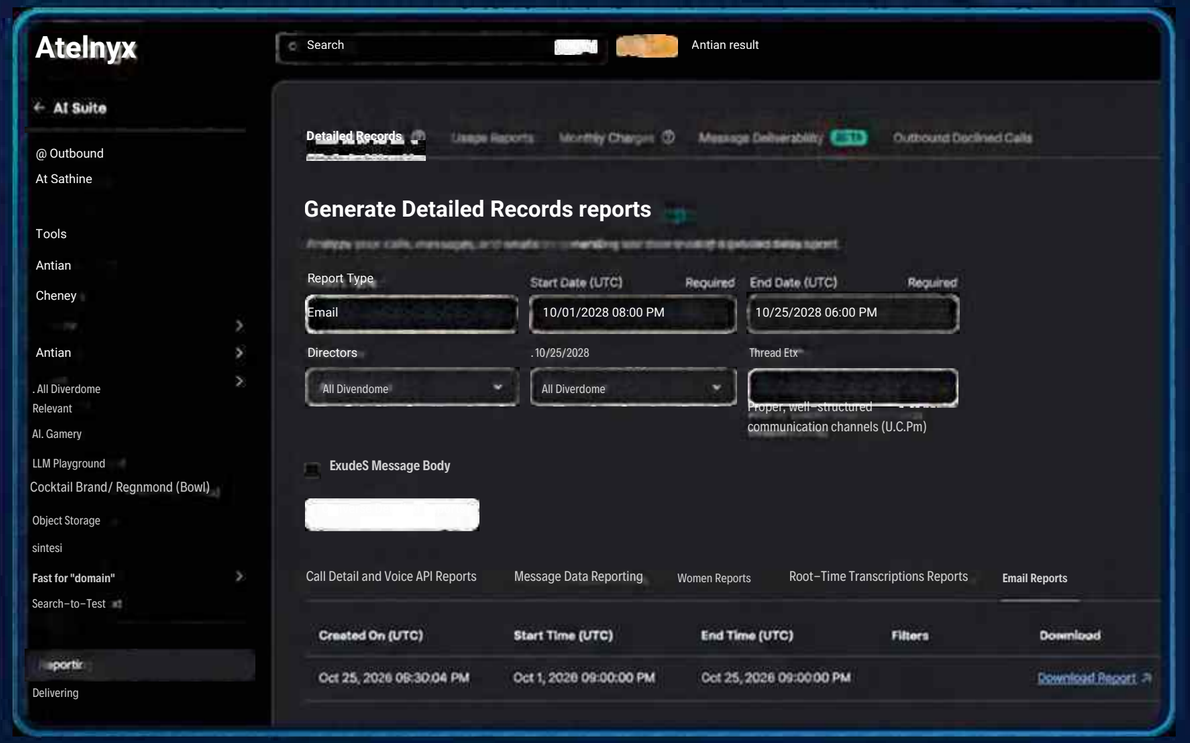
Calls, messages, and emails originate inside the app.

Telnyx Messaging Infrastructure

Telnyx powers reliable delivery across channels and captures delivery and messaging activity.

Reports and Insights

Telnyx turns activity into detailed reports so you can monitor, analyze, and improve communications.



Reliable delivery across channels

Real-time visibility into messaging activity

Detailed reports for every channel

Data-driven insights to monitor and improve performance

TELNYX Voice Metrics

Measure voice activity and outcomes to keep your app reliable and ready to improve.



Dashboard

Voice: Number of Calls



Voice: Connection Rate

Last 7 days



Voice: Max Concurrent Calls

Last 7 days

No connection selected



Active Calls

Real-time

Inbound	Outbound
0	0

Last updated: a few seconds ago

Data that powers every voice experience

Measure Success
Monitor call volume and connection rate to confirm your app is delivering reliable voice experiences.

Spot Failures
Drops in connection rate or low concurrency can signal routing, trunking, or network issues.

Understand Outcomes
Active calls and concurrent usage show real-time demand and customer impact.

Improve Continuously
Use these metrics to prioritize and deliver better experiences and improve call quality over time.

1. Metric Captured
Download a connection rate, conit and active calls as collected in rea time.

2. Outcome Observed
Dowebands reveal what's happening with your voice traffic and quality.

3. Insight Gained
Understand trends, detect customer impact.

4. Improvement Informed
Take action, optimize your setup, and deliver better experiences every day.



TELNYX:
Message Metrics

Measure volume and outcomes to drive app reliability and growth.

METRIC CAPTURED
Track message activity and delivery performance in real time.

OUTCOME OBSERVED
Detect delivery issues and failures using clear, actionable signals.

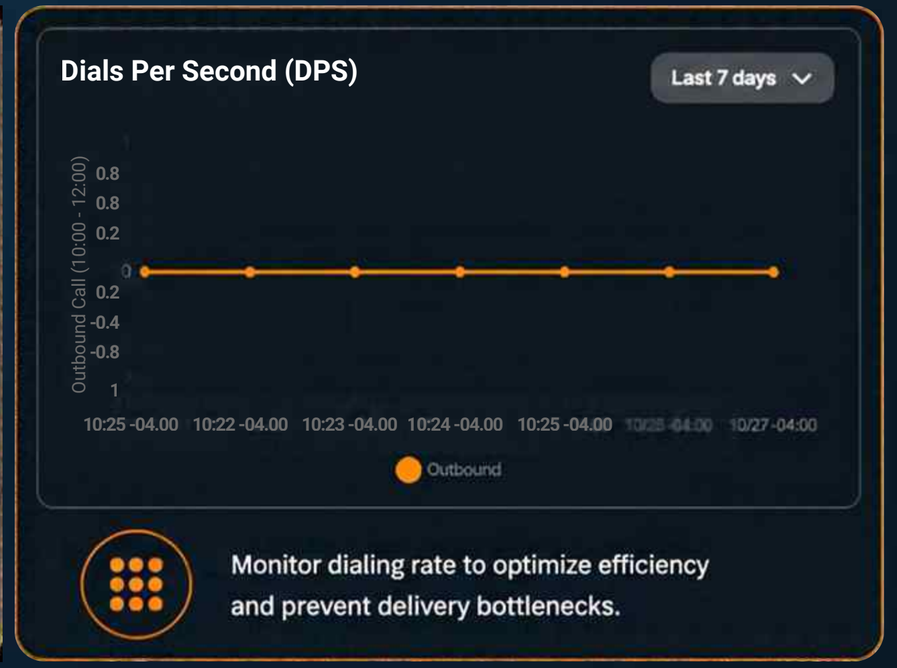
IMPROVEMENT INFORMED
Use insights to prioritize fixes, optimize routes, and improve results.



Monitor overall SMS traffic across all routes to understand usage patterns and capacity.



Track outbound call spikes to ensure voice delivery performance stays strong.



Monitor dialing rate to optimize efficiency and prevent delivery bottlenecks.

Launching the App

01 Start With a Soft Launch

Use a soft launch or controlled beta. Validate onboarding, communication, payments, error handling, and the support experience before expanding.

02 Use Feedback to Improve

Use a soft launch or controlled beta. Validate onboarding, communication, payments, error handling, and the support experience before expanding.





Where I introduce products and find early users

Product Hunt

Launch pages, community comments, upvotes and early product feedback.

F6S

Founder profiles, startup programs, accelerators and partnership opportunities.

X+ TikTok

Build in public, share demos, join conversations and hear what users need.

LinkedIn + Reddit

Industry and interest-based conversations, feedback and problem discovery.

x.com

LAUNCH, FIND, AND BE FOUND.

X is where builders share, start conversations, and connect with early believers.

Share your idea.
Start real conversations.

Find aligned builders
and early supporters.

Build in public.
Turn attention into momentum.



Chinmay Pingale @cppingale · Oct 23

Hi everyone 👋

I have three iOS **apps** heading to the App Store. I need genuine folks to try them first:

📚 Munching: a calorie tracker without the guilt. Miso glows when you log and never judges what you ate. testflight.apple.com/join/VDBRshhpL... page: munchling-site.vercel.app

Darrel Frater @DarrelFrater · Aug 27

Any founders interested in pitching my friends at Black Ops **VC** tomorrow?

They invest $300K - $1.5M at Pre-Seed and Seed in Black-led software and tech-enabled companies.

Comment “DM” below. I’ll send you the invite.

Product Hunt

Discover today's most exciting launches.

265

310

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Search (ctrl + k)

Best Products | Launches | News | Forums | Advertise

Top Products Launching Today

1. TheySaid 4.0
See how users will react, right where you build.
User Experience · Artificial Intelligence - UX Design

86 310

2. Overmind
Open-source platform for continuous learning
Developer Tools · Artificial Intelligence - GitHub

69

3. Orbit
Stop doomsrolling. Earn every app unlock.
iOS · Health & Fitness · Productivity

34 202

4. Spacesheep
Documents of the future, made by AI, read by your team
Productivity · Developer Tools · Artificial Intelligence

19 176

POST-LAUNCH PRACTICE

Maintaining and Updating



Listen to Your Users

Customer experience

01 Monitor

Monitor the actual user experience, not only whether the AI says a feature is complete.

02 Review

Review delivery logs, user feedback, analytics, support issues, and integration status.

03 Secure

Revisit accessibility and security.

04 Prioritize

Prioritize fixes by impact and risk.

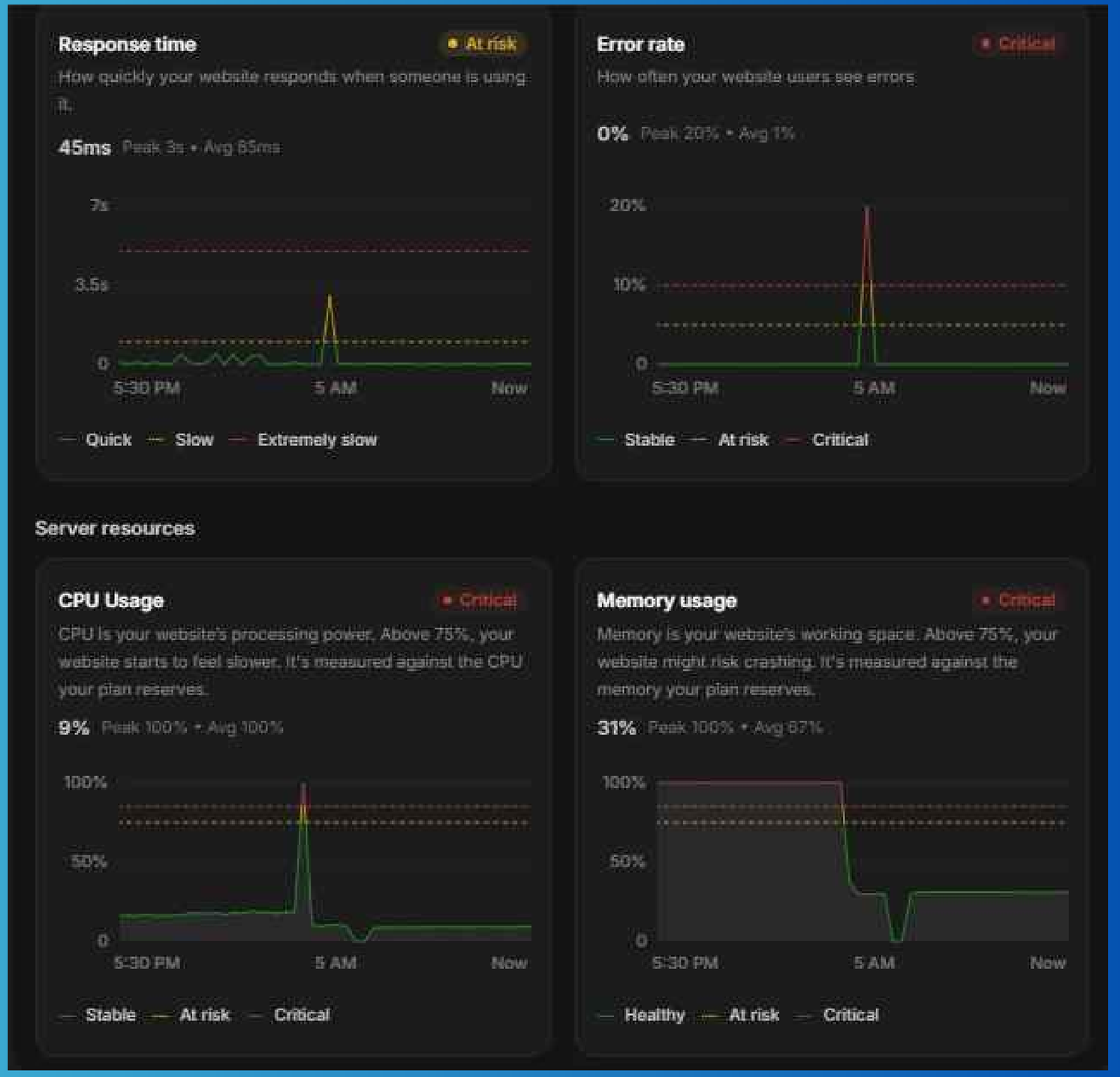
05 Improve

Keep Improving the App

Keep improving the app. Listen to your users and keep the customer experience at the center as you maintain and update.



User Experience





Build With Confidence

1

Start with the problem

2

Treat prompts as specifications

Context, boundaries, milestones and acceptance tests.

3

Stay accountable

AI accelerates creation; humans own quality, trust and product decisions.

Dance to your own beat

Be creative, build
customer in mind
a personal touch



Thank You

Connect with me on Linkedin